

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 576

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Maya Turner for her outstanding contributions to the arts.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those gifted artists whose work enriches our communities, fosters cultural understanding, and reflects the depth of the human experience; and

WHEREAS, one such remarkable individual is Maya Turner, a self-taught artist whose work in wood carving celebrates both her personal journey and the vibrant cultures that inspire her; and

WHEREAS, a practicing artist for more than two decades, Ms. Turner employs a handheld gouge to create intricate carvings of people, animals, and abstract forms in wood, which she then paints in vivid, bold colors that accentuate the richness and beauty of often-overlooked cultures; and

WHEREAS, Maya Turner's art is deeply personal and evocative; as an individual living with epilepsy, she draws from her lived experience, expressing through her work the cycles and changes that occur after a seizure—offering viewers a window into both the complexity of the human brain and the resilience of the human spirit; and

WHEREAS, her work has been featured in art festivals and exhibitions across the nation, including the Tennessee Craft Fair, 100 Taylor Arts Market, the William Edmondson Arts and Culture Fest, Artclectic, the Essence Festival of Culture, SOKO Market, and the Black Girl Art Show in Brooklyn; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Turner's artistic vision—marked by bold lines, vibrant palettes, and cultural reverence—not only beautifies the spaces it inhabits but also uplifts stories and traditions too often marginalized in the broader art world; and

WHEREAS, Maya Turner is a shining example of artistic excellence, authenticity, and perseverance, and she is most worthy of our admiration and appreciation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Maya Turner for her outstanding contributions to this State as a wood carver and visual artist, celebrate her vibrant body of work, and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.